DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Mercy, presumption, and the animals boarding the ark.

Monday, 12 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 7:1-7:16) · Daf Bekhorot 24

FROM THE LINKED SOURCES

When milk doesn't prove motherhood

Jev score: 0.56 — Jev 0.56: does this source illuminate the daf in a non-obvious way, beyond merely being cited by it? (10 candidates; next best 0.46)

The Maharam of Rothenburg (Teshuvot Maharam, Cremona 312) takes up the exact case of our daf: a Jew buys a nursing animal from a gentile and wonders about firstborn status when it gives birth in his house. The ruling follows Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel of Bekhorot 24 — a nursing animal is presumed to have already given birth, so its future offspring is exempt from firstborn sanctity.

Then comes Rabbeinu Tam's sharp inference, quoted in the responsum: it must be the nursing itself that exempts. For if milk alone exempted, why would the law specify a nursing animal with her young trailing after her? The responsum turns the daf's abstract presumption into a working legal test and quietly sharpens it: milk is evidence, but the visible mother-young bond is the proof. What illuminates here is the method — the posek reading the daf not as a closed ruling but as a distinction waiting to be drawn.

PARSHA · NOACH

No strong link this week

Jev score: 0.37 — Jev 0.37 was the best of 6 candidates; below the 0.6 bar for a real connection

The closest candidate Jev could find pairs Noah's vineyard — planted for wine, ending in shame and exposure (Genesis 9:20-21) — with the daf's cleaver ruling: an act whose forbidden-looking consequence was never intended. Both turn on the gap between intention and outcome. But 0.37 is below the bar, and the shared mechanism is abstract; the texts themselves never touch. Verdict: no genuine connection this week, and the section stays honest about it.

Rejected by Jev: the dove/raven presumption (0.33), the rainbow as standing presumption (0.33), ark mother-offspring logistics (0.31), divine remembrance across species (0.24), the unresolved circle of salvation (0.14).

NEWS CHECK

No genuine resonance

Jev score: 0.36 — Jev 0.36 was the best of 8 stories; below the bar

The week's stories were scored against the daf's themes — mercy across boundaries, presumption under uncertainty, intention versus effect. The highest score went to the rescued giraffe Twiggy, sheltered as a calf among zebras: nature's own cross-species mercy,

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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the daf's unresolved question answered in the affirmative. Charming, but 0.36 is a coincidence, not a connection. Nothing this week genuinely resonates.

Rejected by Jev: rights of nature at the UN (0.35), the unconfirmed energy ceasefire (0.30), the Riyadh escalation (0.30), IMF debt meetings (0.26), the diesel deal (0.13), the Nobel Peace Prize (0.12), the hurricanes (0.08).

MAAGARIM · RACHAMIM

רחמים: the word the sugya turns on

The whole of Bekhorot 24 turns on a single noun: רחמים, the mercy of a mother animal. Rabban Shimon ben Gamliel's presumption assumes it; the Sages fear it; the baraita tests whether it stops at the boundary of kin and species. The pig-like creature trailing the ewe is the word's limit case — does mercy cross even the species line? In the end the dilemma 'shall stand unresolved,' and רחמים remains what it was at the start: the sugya's unexplained explainer, the natural fact on which a whole structure of presumptions is built.

Word data: מפעל המילון ההיסטורי של האקדמיה ללשון העברית — the Historical Dictionary Project of the Academy of the Hebrew Language. (Citation sweep partial: the Maagarim site blocked both direct and browser access on 2026-10-12; no attestation count reported. Earliest verified attestation here is the daf's own discussion.)

929 · I KINGS 5 (CH. 292)

Wisdom you can hear in a letter

The chapter moves in three arcs — prosperity (1–8), wisdom (9–14), the Hiram alliance and the Temple preparations (15–32) — and it is hinged on a single verse: 'God had given Solomon wisdom, just as promised' (v26). That is the chapter's thesis: wisdom is the engine behind both the abundance and the alliance. Everything else is demonstration.

The provisions list that opens the chapter (v2–3) — thirty kors of semolina, sixty of flour, ten fattened oxen, a hundred sheep — is not royal bragging. Malbim asks the structural question: why does the chapter serve the menu before describing the dominion (v4)? Because the king's table grows with the greatness of his kingdom — and, crucially, it cost Israel nothing. The subject peoples brought tribute; in Malbim's phrase, Israel 'nursed the milk of the nations.' The abundance is the receipt for fulfilled dominion, not a tax bill. Metzudat David reads 'they brought tribute' (v1) the same way: fear turned into revenue.

'Every family under its own vine and fig tree' (v5): Malbim hears in the idiom a double negative — no war without, no rebellion within. The chapter brackets its prosperity with peace (v4, 'peace on all his borders'), and the image became the Bible's permanent shorthand for it.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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The wisdom catalogue (v9–14) measures Solomon against the whole history of wisdom. ‘As the sand on the seashore’ quietly echoes the Abrahamic promise — Solomon as its fulfillment. Greater than the Kedemites, whom Rashi and Radak identify as the astrologers (‘they knew the constellations’), and than the Egyptians, masters of natural science and its manipulations. Then the four named sages — Ethan, Heman, Chalkol, Darda, sons of Mahol — and the midrash Rashi cites: ‘wiser than all men’ means wiser than Adam, who named the animals; Ethan is Abraham, Heman is Moses (‘in all My house he is trusted’), Chalkol is Joseph (‘and Joseph sustained’), Darda the wilderness generation, and מחול means forgiven the calf. Malbim adds the philosophical edge, via Abravanel: Solomon's wisdom was miraculous — sudden, from first principles — not the slow empirical kind that is prone to error.

The diplomatic gem is Hiram's letter. Malbim notices (v15) that Hiram sends ‘servants,’ not ‘messengers’ as in II Samuel 5 — because no new covenant was needed; the treaty with David passes to the son. And on v21 Malbim, Ralbag, and Metzudat David converge: Hiram's joy is not about the timber. He reads Solomon's wisdom in the letter's very construction — the long preamble about David's wars is a delicate hint that Solomon needs the cedars themselves, which grow best in Hiram's Lebanon. ‘Praised be God, who gave David a wise son’ is praise for rhetoric. Ralbag adds the darker undertone: the letter blends appeasement with veiled threat, since the House will be built for the God who ‘can humble all enemies.’

Hence v26, the hinge: Malbim insists the peace with Hiram came not from David's military shadow but from Solomon's wisdom — which is why the two ‘made a covenant’ of love. Ralbag: ‘because of his wisdom, Hiram loved him.’ The chapter's argument, stated plainly: wisdom does what armies did.

The chapter closes with numbers that are the prose equivalent of the provisions list — 30,000 laborers in monthly shifts, 70,000 porters, 80,000 quarriers, 3,300 supervisors: abundance as theology. And the final gem (v31), where Malbim, Ralbag, Rashi, and Metzudat David all linger: the foundation stones were huge, heavy, costly, hewn square — against the way of the world, which hides cheap stones in foundations. Rashi adds the Sotah tradition: no iron tool was heard in the House while it was built; the stones were dressed outside and fitted inside in silence. The chapter ends where it began: invisible perfection as the signature of divine wisdom. (For the fuller parallel account, see II Chronicles 2, which Metzudat David cites on v21.)

MISHNAH YOMI · OHOLOT 9:11-12

The beehive as a tent

Oholot 9:11

הָיְתָה מֻטָּה עַל צַדָּהּ בָּאֲוִיר וְכַוֶּרֶת מִן הַמֵּת נָתוּן תַּחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, כֹּל שֶׁהוּא כְּנֶגֶד הַזָּוִית, תַּחְתֶּיהָ

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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וְגַבָּהּ, טָמֵא. וְכֹל שֶׁאֵינוֹ כְּנֶגֶד הַזַּיִת, תּוֹכָהּ, טָהוֹר. בְּתוֹכָהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא:

If it was lying on its side in the open air: If an olive-sized [portion] of a corpse was placed below it or above it, everything directly below or above the olive-sized [portion] becomes unclean; but everything that is not directly below or above, and what is within [the hive] remains clean. [If the uncleanness is] within [the hive] everything becomes unclean.

Rambam's commentary: unreachable this morning (Sefaria blocked this machine's IP); the mishnah is printed from the Hebrew and English above.

Oholot 9:12

הָיְתָה גְּבוּהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַּחְתֶּיהָ אוֹ עַל גַּבָּהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא, אַלָּא תוֹכָהּ. בְּתוֹכָהּ, הַכֹּל טָמֵא. בַּמֶּה דְּבָרִים אֲמוּרִים, בִּזְמַן שֶׁהִיא כֶּלִי. הָיְתָה פְּחוּתָה וּפְקוּקָה בְּקַשׁ, אוֹ מַחֲזֶקֶה אַרְבָּעִים סְאָה, כִּדְבְרֵי חֲכָמִים, כַּזַּיִת מִן הַמֵּת נָתוּן תַּחְתֶּיהָ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הַתְּהוֹם טָמֵא. עַל גַּבָּהּ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הָרָקִיעַ טָמֵא. בְּתוֹכָהּ, אֵין טָמֵא אֶלָּא תוֹכָהּ. הָיְתָה גְּבוּהָה מִן הָאָרֶץ טֶפַח, טֻמְאָה תַּחְתֶּיהָ, טָמֵא. בְּתוֹכָהּ, תוֹכָהּ טָמֵא. עַל גַּבָּהּ, כְּנֶגְדּוֹ עַד הָרָקִיעַ טָמֵא:

[In the case where the hive is in the open air] and is one handbreadth high off the ground, if there is uncleanness below it or above it, everything becomes unclean except the inside. [If the uncleanness is] within, everything becomes unclean. When do these rules apply? When [the hive is] a vessel. If it is defective, although [it may be] stopped up with straw or, according to the sages, it contains forty seahs: then if an olive-sized [portion] of a corpse is placed below it, [everything] directly [below] to the depths becomes unclean; [if placed] above, [everything] directly above to the sky becomes unclean. [If the uncleanness is] within [the hive] nothing is unclean except that which is within. [If] it was one handbreadth high off the ground, if there was uncleanness below it, what is below becomes unclean; [if the uncleanness] was within it, what is within becomes unclean; above it, [everything] directly [above] to the sky becomes unclean.

Rambam's commentary: unreachable this morning (Sefaria blocked this machine's IP); the mishnah is printed from the Hebrew and English above.

RAMBAM YOMI · HILCHOT YIBBUM VACHALITZAH 8

Doubt upon doubt: the architecture of uncertainty

Halachah 1

מִי שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ אַחַת מִשְּׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת וְאֵין יָדוּעַ אִי זֶה מֵהֶן קִדֵּשׁ וּמֵת וְלוֹ אָח. אֶחָד חוֹלֵץ לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן כְּדֵי לְהַתִּירָן לַאֲחֵרִים. הָיוּ לוֹ שְׁנֵי אַחִין אֶחָד חוֹלֵץ לְאַחַת מֵהֶן בַּתְּחִלָּה וְהַשֵּׁנִי מְיַבֵּם לַשְּׁנִיָּה עַל כָּל פָּנִים. אִם זוֹ הִיא שֶׁקִּדֵּשׁ אָחִיו הֲרֵי יְבֵּם אוֹתָהּ. וְאִם אֵינָהּ אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו הֲרֵי נָשָׂא אִשָּׁה מִשְּׁאָר הַנָּשִׁים וַאֲחוֹתָהּ שֶׁהָיְתָה אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו כְּבָר נֶחְלְצָה. אֲבָל לֹא יְיַבֵּם הָאַחַת תְּחִלָּה שֶׁמָּא הָאַחֶרֶת הִיא אֵשֶׁת

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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אָחִיו וְנִמְצָא שֶׁנָּשָׂא קְרוֹבַת זְקוּקָתוֹ. קָדְמוּ שְׁנֵי הָאַחִים וְכָנְסוּ שְׁתֵּי הַיְבָמוֹת אֵין מוֹצִיאִין אוֹתָן מִיָּדָן:

[The following rules apply when a man] consecrates one of two sisters, but does not know which one he has consecrated and then dies [childless]. If he has one brother, [the brother] should perform chalitzah with both of them to enable them to marry other men. If he has two brothers, one of them should first perform chalitzah with one of [the sisters], and the other should perform yibbum with the other one [because of the following rationale]: If this was the woman consecrated by his brother, he performed yibbum with her. If she is not his brother's wife, he has married a woman [permitted to him] like any other woman, and chalitzah has already been performed for her sister, his brother's wife. One should not perform yibbum with one of the women first, for perhaps the other was in fact his brother's wife, and he will have married a relative of the woman who is obligated [to perform yibbum with] him. If, without asking Rabbinic advice, each of the brothers married one of the sisters, they are not forced to dissolve the marriage.

Halachah 2

שְׁנַיִם שֶׁקִּדְּשׁוּ שְׁתֵּי אֲחָיוֹת. זֶה אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ אֵי זוֹ קִדֵּשׁ וְזֶה אֵינוֹ יוֹדֵעַ אֵי זוֹ קִדֵּשׁ. וּמֵתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶן. לָזֶה אָח וְלָזֶה אָח. זֶה חוֹלֵץ לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן וְזֶה חוֹלֵץ לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן. לָזֶה אָח אֶחָד וְלָזֶה שְׁנַיִם. הַיְחִידִי חוֹלֵץ לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן בַּתְּחִלָּה וְהַשְּׁנַיִם אֶחָד חוֹלֵץ רִאשׁוֹנָה וְהַשֵּׁנִי מְיַבֵּם. וְאִם קָדְמוּ וְכָנְסוּ אֵין מוֹצִיאִין מִיָּדָן. וַאֲפִלּוּ הָיוּ כֹּהֲנִים שֶׁהַחֲלִיצָה שֶׁחָלַץ הַיְחִידִי מִסָּפֵק חָלַץ וְהַחֲלוּצָה אֲסוּרָה לְכֹהֵן מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים וּבִסָּפֵק חֲלוּצָה לֹא גָזְרוּ:

[The following rule applies when] two [men who are not related,] each having one brother, consecrate two sisters, neither of the men knows which [sister] he consecrated, and they both die [childless]. Each [brother] should perform chalitzah with each of the sisters. [In the above situation, if] one of the deceased has one brother, and the other has two brothers, the one brother should perform chalitzah with both women first, and then one of the two brothers should perform chalitzah [with one woman] first, and the second one [should perform yibbum with the other]. If, [without asking Rabbinic advice, each of the brothers] married [one of the sisters], they are not forced to dissolve the marriage. [The above applies] even if the brothers were priests. [Although] there is a Rabbinic prohibition against a priest marrying a woman who performed chalitzah, the chalitzah performed by this woman was performed because of doubt, and [our Sages] did not enforce a decree with regard to a chalitzah performed because of doubt.

Halachah 3

הָיוּ לָזֶה שְׁנֵי אַחִין וְלָזֶה שְׁנֵי אַחִין. אָחִיו שֶׁל זֶה חוֹלֵץ לְאַחַת וְאָחִיו שֶׁל זֶה חוֹלֵץ לָאַחֶרֶת. וְאַחַר כָּךְ הָאָח הַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁל זֶה מְיַבֵּם חֲלוּצָתוֹ שֶׁל זֶה. וְהָאָח הַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁל זֶה מְיַבֵּם חֲלוּצָתוֹ שֶׁל זֶה. קָדְמוּ שְׁנֵיהֶן וְחָלְצוּ לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן לֹא יְיַבְּמוּ שְׁנֵי הָאַחִין הָאֲחֵרִים. אֶלָּא אֶחָד חוֹלֵץ בַּתְּחִלָּה וְאָחִיו מְיַבֵּם לַשְּׁנִיָּה. וְאִם

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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קָדְמוּ וְכָנְסוּ אֵין מוֹצִיאִין מִיָּדָן:

In the above instance,] if both of the deceased had two brothers, one of one pair of brothers should perform chalitzah with one of the sisters, and one of the other pair of brothers should perform chalitzah with the other sister. Afterwards, the other brother from the first pair should perform yibbum with the sister with whom the brother from the other pair performed chalitzah, and the other brother from the second pair should perform yibbum with the sister with whom the brother from the first pair performed chalitzah. If both [brothers from one pair each] performed chalitzah with [one of the sisters] first, the brothers from the other pair should not both perform yibbum. Instead, one should perform chalitzah [with one of the sisters] first, and then his brother should perform yibbum with the other. If, without asking Rabbinic advice, each of the brothers married one of the sisters, they are not forced to dissolve the marriage.

Halachah 4

הָאִשָּׁה שֶׁהָיוּ לָהּ בָּנִים וְהָיוּ לְכַלָּתָהּ בָּנִים וְנִתְעַבְּרָה הָאִשָּׁה וְנִתְעַבְּרָה כַּלָּתָהּ וְיָלְדוּ שְׁתֵּיהֶן בְּמַחֲבוֹאָה אַחַת וְנִתְעָרְבוּ שְׁנֵי הַיְלָדִים וְהִגְדִּילוּ הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת וְנָשְׂאוּ נָשִׁים וּמֵתוּ. כֵּיצַד הֵן נִתָּרוֹת. בְּנֵי הַכַּלָּה חוֹלְצִין לִשְׁתֵּיהֶן תְּחִלָּה וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין שֶׁכָּל אַחַת מֵהֶן סָפֵק שֶׁהִיא אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו וְתִהְיֶה מֻתֶּרֶת לוֹ, סָפֵק שֶׁהִיא אֵשֶׁת אָחִי אָבִיו וְהִיא עֶרְוָה עָלָיו. אֲבָל בְּנֵי הַזְּקֵנָה אוֹ חוֹלְצִין אוֹ מְיַבְּמִין. שֶׁאִם הִיא זוֹ אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו הֲרֵי יְבָמָה. וְאִם הִיא אֵשֶׁת בֶּן אָחִיו מֻתֶּרֶת לְהִנָּשֵׂא לוֹ שֶׁכְּבָר נֶחְלְצָה:

[The following situation gives rise to several halachic questions:] A woman had sons, and one of her daughters-in-law also had sons. Both the woman and her daughter-in-law became pregnant and they gave birth in the same hiding place. [There was a disturbance] and the identity of the two children became confused [and it was not known who was the son of the mother, and who, the son of the daughter-in-law]. The two sons grew up and married and then died [childless]. How are their wives freed to marry others? First, [one of] the sons of the daughter-in-law should perform chalitzah with [both women]; he should not perform yibbum. [The rationale is that] there is a doubt regarding the identity of each of the women. It is possible that she is the wife of his brother and thus permitted to him, but it is also possible that she is the wife of his father's brother and thus forbidden to him as an ervah. Afterwards,] the sons of the elder woman may perform either chalitzah or yibbum. [With regard to each of the women, the same question applies:] If she is his brother's wife, he is performing yibbum. And if she is the wife of his brother's son, she is permitted to marry him, because she has already performed chalitzah.

Halachah 5

מֵתוּ הַבָּנִים הַיְדוּעִים שֶׁל זְקֵנָה וְשֶׁל כַּלָּתָהּ וַהֲרֵי בְּנֵי הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת קַיָּמִין. בְּנֵי הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת לִנְשֵׁי בְּנֵי הַזְּקֵנָה חוֹלְצִין וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין שֶׁהִיא סְפֵק אֵשֶׁת אָחִי אָבִיו שֶׁהִיא עֶרְוָה עָלָיו, סְפֵק אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו שֶׁהִיא

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מֻתֶּרֶת לְיַבְּמָהּ. וְלִנְשֵׁי בְּנֵי הַכְּלָה אֶחָד חוֹלֵץ בַּתְּחִלָּה וְאֶחָד מְיַבֵּם עַל כָּל פָּנִים. אִם בֶּן הַכְּלָה הוּא שֶׁחָלַץ תְּחִלָּה הֲרֵי חָלַץ אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו וְהַשֵּׁנִי מִן הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת הוּא בֶּן הַזְּקֵנָה וּמֻתָּר לוֹ לִשָּׂא אֵשֶׁת בֶּן אָחִיו אַחַר שֶׁנִּחְלְצָה מִיבָמָהּ. וְאִם זֶה שֶׁחָלַץ תְּחִלָּה הוּא בֶּן הַזְּקֵנָה הֲרֵי חָלַץ לְאֵשֶׁת בֶּן אָחִיו וְלֹא עָשָׂה כְּלוּם וְהַשֵּׁנִי מִן הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת הוּא בֶּן הַכַּלָּה וַהֲרֵי יִבֵּם אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו:

[In the above situation, the following procedure should be carried out if] the sons of the elder woman and her daughter-in-law whose identities had been established died [childless], and the two sons whose identities were confused were alive. The sons whose identities were confused should perform chalitzah with the wives of the elder woman's sons; they may not perform yibbum. [The rationale is that] there is a doubt whether [each woman] is the wife of his father's brother and thus forbidden to him as an ervah, or the wife of his brother and thus permitted to her yavam. With regard to the wives of the sons of the daughter-in-law: First, one should perform chalitzah and the other should perform yibbum. The rationale is that if the son of the daughter-in-law was the one who performed chalitzah first, he performed chalitzah with his brother's wife. The second one of those whose identities were confused was the son of the elder woman. He is permitted to marry the wife of his brother's son after her yavam performed chalitzah with her. If it was the son of the elder woman who performed chalitzah first, he performed chalitzah with the wife of his brother's son, and his deed is of no consequence. The second one of those whose identities were confused was the son of the daughter-in-law, and he performed yibbum with his brother's wife.

Halachah 6

מִי שֶׁלֹּא שָׁהֲתָה אַחַר מִיתַת בַּעְלָהּ שְׁלֹשָׁה חֳדָשִׁים וְנִשֵּׂאת וְיָלְדָה וְאֵין יָדוּעַ אִם בֶּן תִּשְׁעָה לָרִאשׁוֹן אִם בֶּן שִׁבְעָה לָאַחֲרוֹן. וְהָיוּ לָהּ בָּנִים מִן הָרִאשׁוֹן וּמִן הַשֵּׁנִי. אִם מֵת זֶה הַבֵּן הַסָּפֵק. בְּנֵי הָרִאשׁוֹן וּבְנֵי הַשֵּׁנִי חוֹלְצִין לְאִשְׁתּוֹ וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין. שֶׁכָּל אֶחָד מֵהֶן שֶׁיָּבוֹא לְיַבֵּם שֶׁמָּא אֵינוֹ אָחִיו מֵאָבִיו וַהֲרֵי הוּא אָחִיו מֵאִמּוֹ בְּוַדַּאי וְאֵשֶׁת אָחִיו מֵאִמּוֹ אֲסוּרָה עָלָיו לְעוֹלָם מִשּׁוּם עֶרְוָה. וְכֵן זֶה הַבֵּן הַסָּפֵק חוֹלֵץ לִנְשׁוֹתֵיהֶן וְלֹא מְיַבֵּם:

[The following rules apply with regard to] a woman who did not wait three months after the death of her husband [before] remarrying]. She remarried and gave birth, and it is not known whether the child she bore was fathered by the first husband and was born after a full term pregnancy, or whether it was fathered by the second husband and was born after a seven-month pregnancy. If the woman bore other children to both her first and second husbands, and then this son whose [father's identity] is in doubt dies [childless], both the sons of the first husband and the sons of the second husband should perform chalitzah with [the deceased's] wife, but they should not perform yibbum. [The rationale is that the obligation for] each of them to perform yibbum is doubtful, for perhaps he is not the paternal brother [of the deceased]. And he is definitely a maternal brother [of the

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deceased], and the wife of a maternal brother is always forbidden as an ervah. For this same [reason], the son whose [father's identity] is in doubt should perform chalitzah with any of the wives of [his other brothers], but should not perform yibbum.

Halachah 7

הָיָה בֵּן לָרִאשׁוֹן וּבֵן לַשֵּׁנִי שֶׁלֹּא מֵאִשָּׁה זוֹ שֶׁנִּשֵּׂאת בְּתוֹךְ זְמַן וּמֵת אֶחָד מֵהֶן. הֲרֵי הַבֵּן הַסָּפֵק חוֹלֵץ לְאֵשֶׁת זֶה שֶׁמֵּת אוֹ מְיַבֵּם. שֶׁאִם אָחִיו מֵאֲבִיו הוּא הֲרֵי יִבֵּם אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ וְאִם אֵינוֹ אָחִיו מֵאֲבִיו הֲרֵי אֵין בֵּינֵיהֶן אַחֲוָה כְּלָל לְפִיכָךְ מֻתָּר לוֹ לִשָּׂא אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ׃

If both this woman's first and second husbands had fathered another son with another wife, and one of these other sons died [childless], the son whose [father's identity] is in doubt may perform either chalitzah or yibbum with the wife of the deceased. [The rationale is] that if [the deceased] was his paternal brother, then he has performed yibbum. And if he was not his paternal brother, then they have no family connection at all, and he is permitted to marry [the deceased's] wife.

Halachah 8

מֵת הַבֵּן הַסָּפֵק אֶחָד מִשְּׁנֵי הַבָּנִים הַוַּדָּאִין חוֹלֵץ לְאִשְׁתּוֹ תְּחִלָּה וְהַשֵּׁנִי מְיַבֵּם עַל כָּל פָּנִים. אִם אָחִיו הוּא הֲרֵי יִבֵּם אֶת אִשְׁתּוֹ. וְאִם אֵינוֹ אָחִיו וְהוּא בֶּן הָאָב הָאַחֵר הֲרֵי נֶחְלְצָה מֵאֲחִי בַּעְלָהּ׃

[In the above situation,] if the son whose [father's identity] is in doubt dies [childless], one of the two sons whose [father's identity] is known should first perform chalitzah with his wife, and afterwards the second should perform yibbum. [The rationale is that if the deceased] was his brother, then he has performed yibbum. And if he is not his brother, but rather the son of the other father, his wife has already performed chalitzah with her husband's brother [and is permitted to remarry].

Halachah 9

מִי שֶׁהָלַךְ בַּעְלָהּ לִמְדִינָה אַחֶרֶת וְשָׁמְעָה שֶׁמֵּת וְנִשֵּׂאת וְאַחַר כָּךְ בָּא הַבַּעַל הָרִאשׁוֹן וּמֵתוּ שְׁנֵיהֶן וְלָזֶה אַחִין וְלָזֶה אַחִין. אֲחִיו שֶׁל זֶה וַאֲחִיו שֶׁל זֶה חוֹלְצִין וְלֹא מְיַבְּמִין׃

[The following rules apply when] a woman's husband traveled to another country, his wife heard that he died and [on this basis] married another man, and then her first husband returned. If both husbands die [childless], and they both have brothers, one of each husband's brothers should perform chalitzah, but not yibbum.

Halachah 10

חָמֵשׁ נָשִׁים שֶׁהָיָה לְכָל אַחַת מֵהֶן בֵּן יָדוּעַ וְנִתְעַבְּרוּ חֲמִשְׁתָּן וְיָלְדוּ כְּאֶחָד בְּמַחֲבוֹאָה אַחַת חֲמִשָּׁה בָּנִים אֲחֵרִים וְנִתְעָרְבוּ הַיְלָדִים וְהִגְדִּילוּ הַתַּעֲרוֹבוֹת וְנָשְׂאוּ נָשִׁים וּמֵתוּ חֲמִשָּׁה הָאֲנָשִׁים וְנָפְלוּ חָמֵשׁ

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הַנָּשִׁים לִפְנֵי חֲמִשָּׁה הַבָּנִים הַוַּדָּאִין שֶׁאֵין אֶחָד מֵהֶן יוֹדֵעַ אֵי זוֹ הִיא אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו כֵּיצַד תַּקָּנָתָן. אַרְבַּע מֵהֶן חוֹלְצִין לְאַחַת תְּחִלָּה וְהַחֲמִישִׁי יִשָּׂא זוֹ שֶׁנֶּחְלְצָה אַרְבַּע חֲלִיצוֹת עַל כָּל פָּנִים:

[The following rules apply when there were] five women who each had a son whose identity had been established, and then the five women all gave birth together in a hiding place to five other sons, and the identities of the second group of sons became confused to the extent that it was not known who gave birth to whom. The sons whose identity became confused matured and married, and then these five men died [childless] and their five wives fell before the wives of the sons whose identity was known, but none of these sons knows who is the wife of his brother. What must be done [so that these women can remarry]? Four [of the sons whose identity was known] perform chalitzah for one of the wives first, and the fifth son should marry her after she has performed chalitzah four times.

Halachah 11

כֵּיצַד. אִם אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו הִיא הֲרֵי יִבֵּם אוֹתָהּ. וְאִם אֵינָהּ אֵשֶׁת אָחִיו הֲרֵי הִיא אֵשֶׁת אָח אֶחָד מֵאַרְבָּעָה וַהֲרֵי חָלְצוּ לָהּ אַרְבַּעְתָּן תְּחִלָּה. וְכֵן הַשְּׁנִיָּה חוֹלְצִין לָהּ אַרְבָּעָה וְהָאֶחָד מִן הָאַרְבָּעָה יִהְיֶה זֶה שֶׁנָּשָׂא הָרִאשׁוֹנָה וְהַחֲמִישִׁי יִשָּׂאֶנָּה. עַד שֶׁנִּמְצְאוּ הַבָּנִים הַחֲמִשָּׁה נָשְׂאוּ הֶחָמֵשׁ נָשִׁים אַחַר שֶׁנֶּחְלְצָה כָּל אַחַת מֵהֶן אַרְבַּע חֲלִיצוֹת:

What is implied? If the woman was his brother's wife, he has performed yibbum. And if she is not his brother's wife, she is the wife of the brother of one of the other four, and they all performed chalitzah with her first. Similarly, the second woman should have four [of the sons whose identity was known] - including the one who married the first [of the widows] - perform chalitzah with her, and the fifth one should marry her. [This process should be continued] until the five sons have married the five [widows] after each one performed chalitzah four times earlier.

Halachah 12

וּלְעוֹלָם הִזָּהֵר בְּכָל הַסְּפֵקוֹת הַלָּלוּ בְּעִקָּרִים אֵלּוּ. שֶׁכָּל מִי שֶׁנִּסְתַּפֵּק לְךָ שֶׁמָּא בַּת חֲלִיצָה הִיא לְאִישׁ זֶה אוֹ אֵינָהּ צְרִיכָה לַחֲלִיצָה מִמֶּנּוּ. אֵינָהּ נִתֶּרֶת לְהִנָּשֵׂא לְזָר עַד שֶׁיַּחֲלֹץ לָהּ אוֹתוֹ הָאִישׁ. וְכָל מִי שֶׁיִּסְתַּפֵּק לְךָ שֶׁמָּא בִּיאָתָהּ אֲסוּרָה עַל אִישׁ זֶה בֵּין מִדִּבְרֵי תּוֹרָה בֵּין מִדִּבְרֵי סוֹפְרִים אֵינָהּ מִתְיַבֶּמֶת לוֹ. וְכָל שֶׁנֶּחְלְצָה חֲלִיצָה מְעֻלָּה אוֹ נִבְעֲלָה בְּעִילָה כְּשֵׁרָה הֲתִּרָה צָרָתָהּ לְזָר:

When dealing with questionable situations of this nature, one should always have these principles at hand: When there is a doubt whether a woman is required to perform chalitzah with a particular man or not, she is not permitted to marry another man until that [first] man performs chalitzah with her. Whenever there is a doubt whether a woman is forbidden to engage in relations with a man - whether because of a Scriptural prohibition or a Rabbinic prohibition - she should not perform yibbum with him. Whenever a woman has performed a "superior chalitzah" or "acceptable relations," another woman who was

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married to the same husband is permitted to marry another man.

Halachah 13

וְעַל דֶּרֶךְ זוֹ תָּבִין וְתוֹרֶה בְּכָל הַסְּפֵקוֹת שֶׁיֵּאָרְעוּ לְעִנְיַן יִבּוּם וַחֲלִיצָה שֶׁהֲרֵי בֵּאַרְנוּ כָּל הָעִקָּרִין שֶׁעֲלֵיהֶן תִּסְמֹךְ וְתֵדַע מִי הוּא שֶׁחוֹלֵץ וּמִי הוּא שֶׁמְּיַבֵּם וּמִי הִיא הַפְּטוּרָה מִן הַחֲלִיצָה וּמִן הַיִּבּוּם וּמִי הִיא הָרְאוּיָה לְיַבֵּם: סְלִיקוּ לְהוּ הִלְכוֹת יִבּוּם וַחֲלִיצָה בְּסַיְעָתָא דִּשְׁמַיָּא

Following the above patterns, you will be able to understand and rule with regard to any questionable situations that will arise with regard to yibbum and chalitzah. For we have explained all the fundamental principles on which one should rely. You will know who should perform chalitzah, who should perform yibbum, who is not obligated to perform chalitzah or yibbum and who is fit to perform yibbum. With God's help, this concludes "The Laws of Yibbum and Chalitzah."

Commentary

The chapter is built as a cascade: halachot 1–11 parade eleven cases of confused identity — a man consecrates one of two sisters and dies (1–3); two men's consecrations, two sisters, both dead (2–3); children mixed up at birth in a hiding place (4–5, 10–11); a child of doubtful paternity (6–8); the woman who remarried on a rumor of her husband's death (9). Each case varies the doubt along a different axis: whose widow is she? whose brother is he? whose child is this?

Then halachah 12 does the Rambam's signature move: it compresses the thicket into two portable principles to keep ‘always at hand.’ Where there is doubt whether chalitzah is owed, the woman may not remarry until chalitzah is performed; where there is doubt whether relations are forbidden, treat them as forbidden. Chalitzah is the safe universal solvent — where yibbum in doubt would risk a forbidden union, chalitzah releases without creating a bond. Halachah 13 closes methodologically: from these patterns, ‘you will know how to rule in any case that arises.’

The operative logic throughout is that irreducible uncertainty is managed, not solved. The five confused families of halachot 10–11 are never untangled; they are processed — chalitzah all around, then carefully ordered remarriage. It is the halakhic cousin of the daf's ‘until Elijah comes’: some knots are lived with, not untied.

And the resonance with today's daf (Bekhorot 24) is hard to miss: both texts orbit the same question — identity under uncertainty. The daf asks ‘whose offspring is this?’ (the nursing animal, the pig-like creature trailing the ewe); the Rambam asks ‘whose widow is she, whose brother is he?’ Both answer with presumptions and safe procedures rather than omniscience.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

DAILY READER

PARSHAT NOACH

Mercy, presumption, and the animals boarding the ark.

Monday, 12 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 7:1-7:16) · Daf Bekhorot 24

Chapter text: Sefaria (JPS translation). The classical commentaries (Maggid Mishneh, Ohr Sameach) were unreachable this morning — Sefaria blocked this machine's IP — so the synthesis above is general learning notes grounded in the Rambam's own text, not attributed commentary positions.

GOV.IL ·

The state runs the machinery of today's daf

The Israeli state operates the living halakhic infrastructure behind Tractate Bekhorot — including one service page that meets today's daf almost verse for verse.

בקשה לקבלת היתר למכירת בכורות בקר או צאן

הרבנות הראשית לישראל

A gov.il service page letting cattle and sheep farmers apply for a permit to sell their firstborn animals — the modern, state-run version of the very mechanism (selling the firstborn to avoid its sanctity) that the whole tractate, and today's daf on nursing animals and firstborn status, is built around. The central sale happens before Passover each year.

https://www.gov.il/he/service/permit-to-sell-the-firstborns-of-cattle-or-sheep

SHNAYIM MIKRA · ALIYAH 2

Genesis 7:1-7:16

The shnayim mikra practice — each verse twice in Hebrew, once in Targum — slows the reader to the pace of the text itself. Today's second aliyah of Noach (Genesis 7:1–16) is the boarding: the seven-day warning, the clean and unclean animals entering by pairs, and the sealing of the ark — ‘and God shut him in.’

אלהתבה לתבותא

Genesis 7:1 · ×2

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה֙ לְנֹ֔חַ בֹּ֥א אַתָּ֖ה וְכָל־בֵּיתְךָ֑ אֶל־הַתֵּבָ֗ה כִּֽי־אֹתְךָ֥ רָאִ֛יתִי צַדִּ֥יק לְפָנַ֖י בַּדּ֥וֹר הַזֶּֽה׃

וַיֹּאמֶר יְהוָה֙ לְנֹ֔חַ בֹּ֥א אַתָּ֖ה וְכָל־בֵּיתְךָ֑ אֶל־הַתֵּבָ֗ה כִּֽי־אֹתְךָ֥ רָאִ֛יתִי צַדִּ֥יק לְפָנַ֖י בַּדּ֥וֹר הַזֶּֽה׃

וַאֲמַר יְיָ לְנֹחַ עוּל אַתְּ וְכָל אֱנָשׁ בֵּיתָךְ לְתֵבוּתָא אֲרֵי יָתָךְ חֲזֵיתִי זַכַּאי קֳדָמַי בְּדָרָא הָדֵין׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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שבעה

Genesis 7:2 · ×2

מִכֹּל | הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהוֹרָה תִּקַּח־לְךָ שִׁבְעָה שִׁבְעָה אִישׁ וְאִשְׁתּוֹ
וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא טְהֹרָה הִוא שְׁנַיִם אִישׁ וְאִשְׁתּוֹ:
מִכֹּל | הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהוֹרָה תִּקַּח־לְךָ שִׁבְעָה שִׁבְעָה אִישׁ וְאִשְׁתּוֹ
וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר לֹא טְהֹרָה הִוא שְׁנַיִם אִישׁ וְאִשְׁתּוֹ:
מִכֹּל בְּעִירָא דַכְיָא תִּסַּב לָךְ שַׁבְעָא שַׁבְעָא דְּכַר וְנָקְבָא וּמִן בְּעִירָא דְּלָא
(אִיתָהָא) דַכְיָא הִיא תְּרֵין דְּכַר וְנָקְבָא:

ארעא

Genesis 7:3 · ×2

גַּם מֵעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם שִׁבְעָה שִׁבְעָה זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה לְחַיּוֹת זֶרַע עַל־פְּנֵי
כָל־הָאָרֶץ:
גַּם מֵעוֹף הַשָּׁמַיִם שִׁבְעָה שִׁבְעָה זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה לְחַיּוֹת זֶרַע עַל־פְּנֵי
כָל־הָאָרֶץ:
אַף מֵעוֹפָא דִשְׁמַיָּא שַׁבְעָא שַׁבְעָא דְּכַר וְנָקְבָא לְקַיָּמָא זַרְעָא עַל אַפֵּי כָל
אַרְעָא:

עלהארץ

Genesis 7:4 · ×2

כִּי לְיָמִים עוֹד שִׁבְעָה אָנֹכִי מַמְטִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים
לָיְלָה וּמָחִיתִי אֶת־כָּל־הַיְקוּם אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה:
כִּי לְיָמִים עוֹד שִׁבְעָה אָנֹכִי מַמְטִיר עַל־הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים
לָיְלָה וּמָחִיתִי אֶת־כָּל־הַיְקוּם אֲשֶׁר עָשִׂיתִי מֵעַל פְּנֵי הָאֲדָמָה:
אֲרֵי לְזִמַן יוֹמִין עוֹד שַׁבְעָא אֲנָא מָחֵת מִטְרָא עַל אַרְעָא אַרְבְּעִין יְמָמִין
וְאַרְבְּעִין לֵילְוָן וְאֶמְחֵי יָת כָּל יְקוּמָא דִי עֲבָדֵת מֵעַל אַפֵּי אַרְעָא:

Genesis 7:5 · ×2

וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּהוּ יְהוָה:
וַיַּעַשׂ נֹחַ כְּכֹל אֲשֶׁר־צִוָּהוּ יְהוָה:
וַעֲבַד נֹחַ כְּכֹל דִּי פַקְּדֵיהּ יְיָ:

Genesis 7:6 · ×2

וְנֹחַ בֶּן־שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וְהַמַּבּוּל הָיָה מַיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ:
וְנֹחַ בֶּן־שֵׁשׁ מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה וְהַמַּבּוּל הָיָה מַיִם עַל־הָאָרֶץ:
וְנֹחַ בַּר שִׁתְּ מְאָה שְׁנִין וְטוֹפָנָא הֲוָה מַיָּא עַל אַרְעָא:

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Genesis 7:7 · ×2

וַיָּבֹא נֹחַ וּבָנָיו וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתּוֹ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה מִפְּנֵי מֵי הַמַּבּוּל׃
וַיָּבֹא נֹחַ וּבָנָיו וְאִשְׁתּוֹ וּנְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתּוֹ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה מִפְּנֵי מֵי הַמַּבּוּל׃
וְעָאל נֹחַ וּבְנוֹהִי וְאִתְּתֵיהּ וּנְשֵׁי בְנוֹהִי עִמֵּיהּ לְתֵבוּתָא מִן קֳדָם מֵי טוֹפָנָא׃

Genesis 7:8 · ×2

מִן־הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהוֹרָה וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר אֵינֶנָּה טְהֹרָה וּמִן־הָעוֹף וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־רֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאֲדָמָה׃
מִן־הַבְּהֵמָה הַטְּהוֹרָה וּמִן־הַבְּהֵמָה אֲשֶׁר אֵינֶנָּה טְהֹרָה וּמִן־הָעוֹף וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־רֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאֲדָמָה׃
מִן בְּעִירָא דַּכְיָא וּמִן בְּעִירָא דְּי לֵיתַהָא דַּכְיָא וּמִן עוֹפָא וְכֹל דְּי רָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 7:9 · ×2

שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם בָּאוּ אֶל־נֹחַ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ׃
שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם בָּאוּ אֶל־נֹחַ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֱלֹקִים אֶת־נֹחַ׃
תְּרֵין תְּרֵין עֲלוּ לְוָת נֹחַ לְתֵבוּתָא דְּכַר וְנָקְבָא כְּמָא דִּי פַקֵּיד יְיָ יָת נֹחַ׃

Genesis 7:10 · ×2

וַיְהִי לְשִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים וּמֵי הַמַּבּוּל הָיוּ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַיְהִי לְשִׁבְעַת הַיָּמִים וּמֵי הַמַּבּוּל הָיוּ עַל־הָאָרֶץ׃
וַהֲוָה לְזִמְנָא שְׁבְעָת יוֹמִין וּמֵי טוֹפָנָא הֲווֹ עַל אַרְעָא׃

Genesis 7:11 · ×2

בִּשְׁנַת שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה לְחַיֵּי־נֹחַ בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה־עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה נִבְקְעוּ
כָּל־מַעְיְנֹת*(בספרי ספרד ואשכנז מַעְיְנוֹת) תְּהוֹם רַבָּה וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמַיִם נִפְתָּחוּ׃
בִּשְׁנַת שֵׁשׁ־מֵאוֹת שָׁנָה לְחַיֵּי־נֹחַ בַּחֹדֶשׁ הַשֵּׁנִי בְּשִׁבְעָה־עָשָׂר יוֹם לַחֹדֶשׁ בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה נִבְקְעוּ
כָּל־מַעְיְנֹת*(בספרי ספרד ואשכנז מַעְיְנוֹת) תְּהוֹם רַבָּה וַאֲרֻבֹּת הַשָּׁמַיִם נִפְתָּחוּ׃
בִּשְׁנַת שִׁתְּ מְאָה שְׁנִין לְחַיֵּי נֹחַ בְּיַרְחָא תְּנִינָא בְּשִׁבְעַת עַשְׂרָא יוֹמָא לְיַרְחָא בְּיוֹמָא הָדֵין אִתְבְּזָעוּ כָּל מַבּוּעֵי תְּהוֹמָא רַבָּא וְכַוֵּי שְׁמַיָּא אִתְפַּתָּחוּ׃

Genesis 7:12 · ×2

וַיְהִי הַגֶּשֶׁם עַל־הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים לָיְלָה׃
וַיְהִי הַגֶּשֶׁם עַל־הָאָרֶץ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים לָיְלָה׃
וַהֲוָה מִטְרָא נָחֵת עַל אַרְעָא אַרְבְּעִין יְמִמִין וְאַרְבְּעִין לֵילְוָן׃

Genesis 7:13 · ×2

בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בָּא נֹחַ וְשֵׁם־וְחָם וָיֶפֶת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ וְאֵשֶׁת נֹחַ וּשְׁלֹשֶׁת נְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתָּם אֶל־הַתֵּבָה׃
בְּעֶצֶם הַיּוֹם הַזֶּה בָּא נֹחַ וְשֵׁם־וְחָם וָיֶפֶת בְּנֵי־נֹחַ וְאֵשֶׁת נֹחַ וּשְׁלֹשֶׁת נְשֵׁי־בָנָיו אִתָּם אֶל־הַתֵּבָה׃
בְּכַרָן יוֹמָא הָדֵין עָל נֹחַ וְשֵׁם וְחָם וְיֶפֶת בְּנֵי נֹחַ וְאִתַּת נֹחַ וּתְלָתָא נְשֵׁי בְנוֹהִי עִמְּהוֹן לְתֵבוּתָא׃

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Monday, 12 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 7:1-7:16) · Daf Bekhorot 24

Genesis 7:14 · ×2

הֵמָּה וְכָל־הַחַיָּה לְמִינָהּ וְכָל־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ וְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְמִינֵהוּ וְכָל־הָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ כֹּל צִפּוֹר כָּל־כָּנָף׃

הֵמָּה וְכָל־הַחַיָּה לְמִינָהּ וְכָל־הַבְּהֵמָה לְמִינָהּ וְכָל־הָרֶמֶשׂ הָרֹמֵשׂ עַל־הָאָרֶץ לְמִינֵהוּ וְכָל־הָעוֹף לְמִינֵהוּ כֹּל צִפּוֹר כָּל־כָּנָף׃

אִנּוּן וְכָל חַיְתָא לְזַנַּהּ וְכָל בְּעִירָא לְזַנַּהּ וְכָל רְחֵשָׁא דְּרָחֵשׁ עַל אַרְעָא לְזַנּוֹהִי וְכָל עוֹפָא לְזַנּוֹהִי כֹּל צִפַּר כָּל דְּפָרַח׃

Genesis 7:15 · ×2

וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־נֹחַ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם מִכָּל־הַבָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים׃

וַיָּבֹאוּ אֶל־נֹחַ אֶל־הַתֵּבָה שְׁנַיִם שְׁנַיִם מִכָּל־הַבָּשָׂר אֲשֶׁר־בּוֹ רוּחַ חַיִּים׃

וְעַלּוּ עִם נֹחַ לְתֵבוּתָא תְּרֵין תְּרֵין מִכָּל בִּשְׂרָא דִּי בֵיהּ רוּחָא דְחַיֵּי׃

Genesis 7:16 · ×2

וְהַבָּאִים זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּאוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים וַיִּסְגֹּר יְהוָה בַּעֲדוֹ׃

וְהַבָּאִים זָכָר וּנְקֵבָה מִכָּל־בָּשָׂר בָּאוּ כַּאֲשֶׁר צִוָּה אֹתוֹ אֱלֹקִים וַיִּסְגֹּר יְהוָה בַּעֲדוֹ׃

וְעַלַּיָא דְּכַר וְנָקְבָא מִכָּל בִּשְׂרָא עַלוּ כְּמָא דִּי פַקֵּיד יָתֵיהּ יְיָ וַאֲגַן יְיָ (בְּמֵימְרֵיהּ) עֲלוֹהִי׃

Commentary quick hits

Shadal · Gen 7:4

היקום occurs only three times in all of Tanakh — twice in this chapter, once in Deuteronomy 11:6. From the root קום: 'living things,' because the living stand upright on their own.

Ibn Ezra · Gen 7:4

'In yet seven days': the warning came on the 10th of the second month, and after forty days the sun 'returned to its proper place' — an astronomical secret. And יקום is found nowhere else in Scripture.

HaKtav VeHaKabalah · Gen 7:2

שבעה שבעה means seven males and seven females (Bereshit Rabbah); the clean were taken in greater number because they sustain human life. He answers Rashi's sacrifice-reading via Ramban: 'to keep seed alive' is the promise that the sacrifices will preserve Noah's line.

Em LaMikra · Gen 7:11

The 17th of Marheshvan was the day the Pleiades (כימה) rise from the sea; the ancients tied the stars' courses to the weather — citing Pliny and Servius on Virgil about rain-bringing constellations.

Onkelos: translation notes

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Gen 7:1

זכאי קדמי צדיק לפני

The קדם periphrasis: Onkelos never lets ‘before Me’ sound spatial — divine presence is always mediated.

Gen 7:1

עול בא

‘Come’ becomes ‘enter / go up’ — the ark is an ascent, not an approach.

Gen 7:2

דכר ונקבא איש ואשתו

For animals, Onkelos strips the marital language to bare sex — husband-and-wife is a human institution.

Gen 7:4

מחת מטרא ממטיר

The causative verb is unpacked periphrastically — ‘brings down rain.’

Gen 7:6

טופנא המבול

Onkelos consistently renders מבול as טופנא (deluge), refusing a calque.

Gen 7:7

מן קדם מפני

‘From before the waters’ becomes מן קדם — the spatial preposition theologized.

Gen 7:9

ייי אלקים

Where the Hebrew says Elohim commanded, Onkelos writes the Tetragrammaton — the commander here is the covenant God.

Gen 7:16

עלוהי *(במימריה)* ואגן ייי ויסגר יהוה בעדו

The famous memra insertion — God does not physically ‘shut’ the ark; He shields it with His Memra. The verse's most anthropomorphic moment becomes its most theological.

RASHI

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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Rashi on the day's aliyah

All twenty of Rashi's comments on the day's aliyah, printed in full — the boarding of the ark through his eyes: why ‘righteous’ but not ‘righteous and wholehearted,’ how Noah knew which animals were clean, and why the rain came first in mercy.

ראיתי צדיק.

וְלֹא נֶאֱמַר צַדִּיק תָּמִים, מִכָּאן שֶׁאוֹמְרִים מִקְצַת שִׁבְחוֹ שֶׁל אָדָם בְּפָנָיו וְכֻלּוֹ שֶׁלֹּא בְּפָנָיו (ב"ר):

ראיתי צדיק *[THEE] HAVE I SEEN RIGHTEOUS — It does not say “righteous and wholehearted” (as it does at the beginning of the Sedrah);*

hence we may infer that only a part of a man’s good qualities should be enumerated in his presence (since here God is speaking to Noah and calls him only “righteous”), but that in his absence the whole of his good qualities may be told (since when the Torah speaks about him in the earlier passage it calls him “righteous and wholehearted”) (Eruvin 18b).

הטהורה.

הָעֲתִידָה לִהְיוֹת טְהוֹרָה לְיִשְׂרָאֵל; לְמַדְנוּ שֶׁלָּמַד נֹחַ תּוֹרָה (שם פ' כ"ו):

הטהורה *CLEAN—It means those cattle which will in future be permitted to Israel as clean;*

we thus learn that Noah studied the Torah.

שבעה שבעה.

כְּדֵי שֶׁיַּקְרִיב מֵהֶם קָרְבָּן בְּצֵאתוֹ:

שבעה שבעה *SEVEN AND SEVEN — so many, in order that he might offer some of them as a sacrifice when leaving the Ark (Genesis Rabbah 34:9).*

גם מעוף השמים וגו'.

בְּטְהוֹרִים הַכָּתוּב מְדַבֵּר, וְלָמַד סָתוּם מִן הַמְפֹרָשׁ:

גם מעוף השמים וגו' *OF FOWLS ALSO OF THE AIR — Scripture here means “clean” birds just as the animals in verse 2 are stated to be clean, for what is not explicitly stated may be learned by analogy from what is explicitly stated.*

כי לימים עוד שבעה.

אֵלּוּ ז' יְמֵי אֵבְלוֹ שֶׁל מְתוּשֶׁלַח הַצַּדִּיק שֶׁחָס הַקָּבָ"ה עַל כְּבוֹדוֹ וְעִכֵּב אֶת הַפֻּרְעָנוּת.

כי לימים עוד שבעה *FOR YET SEVEN DAYS — These are the seven days of mourning for the righteous man Methuselah for whose honour the Holy One, blessed be He, had regard, and therefore postponed punishment.*

צֵא וַחֲשֹׁב שְׁנוֹתָיו שֶׁל מְתוּשֶׁלַח וְתִמְצָא שֶׁהֵם כָּלִים בְּשָׁנַת ת"ר שָׁנָה לְחַיֵּי נֹחַ (סנה' ק"ח):

Go and calculate the years of Methuselah and you will find that they came to an end (i. e. he died) in the six hundredth year of Noah’s life (which coincided with the date of the Flood) (Sanhedrin 108b).

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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כי לימים עוד.

מַהוּ עוֹד? זְמַן אַחַר זְמַן זֶה נוֹסֵף עַל ק"כ שָׁנָה:

כי לימים עוד *FOR YET [SEVEN] DAYS — What is meant by* עוד *"yet", "more"?*

A further period of time:

this period (seven days) additional to the 120 years of respite that was promised (Sanhedrin 108b).

ארבעים יום.

כְּנֶגֶד יְצִירַת הַוָּלָד, שֶׁקִּלְקְלוּ לְהַטְרִיחַ לְיוֹצְרָם לְצוּר צוּרַת מַמְזֵרִים:

ארבעים יום *FORTY DAYS — corresponding to the period of a child's formation, for by their sinning they had troubled their Creator to form embryos of illegitimate children (Genesis Rabbah 32:5).*

ויעש נח.

זֶה בִּיאָתוֹ לַתֵּבָה:

ויעש נח *AND NOAH DID — This refers to his coming to the Ark.*

נח ובניו.

הָאֲנָשִׁים לְבַד וְהַנָּשִׁים לְבַד, לְפִי שֶׁנֶּאֶסְרוּ בְּתַשְׁמִישׁ הַמִּטָּה מִפְּנֵי שֶׁהָעוֹלָם שָׁרוּי בְּצַעַר:

נח ובניו *NOAH AND HIS SONS — The men separately and the women separately, because they were forbidden to live together as man and wife since the world was living in a state of distress*

מפני מי המבול.

אַף נֹחַ מִקְּטַנֵּי אֲמָנָה הָיָה, מַאֲמִין וְאֵינוֹ מַאֲמִין שֶׁיָּבֹא הַמַּבּוּל,

מפני מי המבול *BECAUSE OF THE WATERS OF THE FLOOD — (*מפני *properly means "from before") — Noah, also, was of those people who are wanting in faith:*

וְלֹא נִכְנַס לַתֵּבָה עַד שֶׁדְּחָקוּהוּ הַמַּיִם:

he believed and he did not believe that the Flood would come, and he would not enter the Ark until the waters forced him to do so (Genesis Rabbah 32:6).

שנים שנים.

כֻּלָּם הֻשְׁווּ בְּמִנְיָן זֶה מִן הַפָּחוּת הָיוּ שְׁנַיִם:

שנים שנים *TWO AND TWO —In this number they were all equal — the least number was two.*

באו אל נח.

מֵאֲלֵיהֶן:

באו אל נח *THEY CAME TO NOAH — of their own accord (Genesis Rabbah 32).*

בחודש השני.

רַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר אוֹמֵר זֶה מַרְחֶשְׁוָן; רַבִּי יְהוֹשֻׁעַ אוֹמֵר זֶה אִיָּר (ר"ה י"א):

בחדש השני *IN THE SECOND MONTH — Rabbi Eliezer said, "This is the month Marcheshvan";*

Rabbi Joshua said, "This is the month Eyar (Rosh Hashanah 11b).

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נבקעו.

לְהוֹצִיא מֵימֵיהֶן:

נבקעו *WERE BROKEN UP — so that they might give forth their waters.*

תהום רבה.

מִדָּה כְּנֶגֶד מִדָּה, הֵם חָטְאוּ בְּרַבָּה רַעַת הָאָדָם וְלָקוּ בִּתְהוֹם רַבָּה:

תהום רבה *THE GREAT DEEP — Measure for measure:*

they had sinned with רבה רעת האדם *"great was the evil of man" (i. e. their sin is described by the word* רבה *"great") and they were therefore punished by* תהום רבה *"the great deep" (i.e.*

the expression "great" is used of the instrument by which they were punished for their great sin) (Sanhedrin 108a).

ויהי הגשם על הארץ.

וּלְהַלָּן הוּא אוֹמֵר וַיְהִי הַמַּבּוּל? אֶלָּא כְּשֶׁהוֹרִידָן בְּרַחֲמִים, שֶׁאִם יַחְזְרוּ יִהְיוּ גִּשְׁמֵי בְרָכָה; כְּשֶׁלֹּא חָזְרוּ הָיוּ לְמַבּוּל:

ויהי הגשם על הארץ *AND THE RAIN WAS UPON THE EARTH — But later on (v. 17) it says. "And the Flood was upon the earth"!*

But the explanation is this:

when He poured down the water at first He made it fall in mercy (gently), in order that if the people would repent, it might prove a rain of blessing;

but when they did not repent it became a destructive flood (Genesis Rabbah 31:12) .

ארבעים יום וגו'.

אֵין יוֹם רִאשׁוֹן מִן הַמִּנְיָן, לְפִי שֶׁאֵין לֵילוֹ עִמּוֹ שֶׁהֲרֵי כְּתִיב בַּיּוֹם הַזֶּה נִבְקְעוּ כָּל מַעְיְנוֹת,

ארבעים יום וגו' *FORTY DAYS AND [FORTY NIGHTS] — The first day is not included in this number, because its night (i.e.*

נִמְצְאוּ אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם כְּלִים בְּכ"ח בְּכִסְלֵו לְרַבִּי אֱלִיעֶזֶר,

the night that preceded it, since according to Jewish reckoning a "day" comprises night-time and the following day-time) was not included with it — for it is written (v. 11) "On the same day (i. e. day-time) were all the fountains of the great deep broken up".

שֶׁהַחֳדָשִׁים נִמְנִין כְּסִדְרָן אֶחָד מָלֵא וְאֶחָד חָסֵר, הֲרֵי י"ב מִמֵּרְחֶשְׁוָן וְכ"ח מִכִּסְלֵו:

(Consequently the forty days ended, according to R. Eliezer, on the 28th day of Kislev (Rosh Hashanah 11b).

as the months are counted as regular months, one full (of 30 days) and the next defective (of 29 days), so we have, 12 days of Marcheshvan and 28 days of Kislev.

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בעצם היום הזה.

לְמֶדְךָ הַכָּתוּב שֶׁהָיוּ בְנֵי דוֹרוֹ אוֹמְרִים אִלּוּ אָנוּ רוֹאִים אוֹתוֹ נִכְנָס לַתֵּבָה, אָנוּ שׁוֹבְרִין אוֹתָהּ וְהוֹרְגִין אוֹתוֹ,

בעצם היום הזה *IN THE SELFSAME DAY — Scripture teaches you that the people of his generation said: "If we see him enter the Ark we will smash it up and kill him".*

אָמַר הַקָּבָ"ה אֲנִי מַכְנִיסוֹ לְעֵינֵי כֻלָּם וְנִרְאֶה דְּבַר מִי יָקוּם:

The Holy One, blessed be He, thereupon said, "I will let him enter before the eyes of everyone and we shall see whose word prevails" (Genesis Rabbah 32:8).

צפור כל כנף.

דָּבוּק הוּא, צִפּוֹר שֶׁל כָּל מִין כָּנָף, לְרַבּוֹת חֲגָבִים (כָּנָף לְשׁוֹן נוֹצָה, כְּמוֹ וְשִׁסַּע אֹתוֹ בִּכְנָפָיו, שֶׁאֲפִלּוּ נוֹצָתָהּ עוֹלָה, אַף כָּאן צִפּוֹר כָּל מִין מַרְאִית נוֹצָה):

צפור כל כנף *[EVERY] BIRD OF EVERY KIND — The word* צפור *is in the construct state, viz..*

birds of every kind of wing, thus including locusts (Chullin 139b).

The word כנף *means "wingfeather", as (Leviticus 1:17) "He shall rend it by the wings thereof", for even its feathers were offered as a sacrifice.*

Also here, the meaning is, birds with any kind of semblance of wing.

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

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ויסגור ה' בעדו.

הֵגֵן עָלָיו שֶׁלֹּא יִשְׁבְּרוּהָ, הִקִּיף הַתֵּבָה דֻּבִּים וַאֲרָיוֹת וְהָיוּ הוֹרְגִים בָּהֶם;

ויסגור ה' בעדו AND THE LORD SHUT HIM IN — He protected him so that they could not smash up the Ark (cf.

5:13):

He surrounded the Ark (thus enclosing it סגר) with bears and lions which killed some of them (Genesis Rabbah 32:8).

וּפְשׁוּטוֹ שֶׁל מִקְרָא סָגַר כְּנֶגְדּוֹ מִן הַמַּיִם,

But the literal meaning of the text is:

He shut the door in front of him against the waters.

Similarly, wherever בעד occurs in the Scriptures it means כנגד in front of.

E. g., (20:18) "The lord had made a closure in front of (בעד) every womb";

וְכֵן כָּל בְּעַד שֶׁבַּמִּקְרָא לְשׁוֹן כְּנֶגֶד הוּא, בְּעַד כָּל רֶחֶם (בראשית כ':י"ח), בַּעֲדֵךְ וּבְעַד בָּנַיִךְ (מ"ב ד'), עוֹר בְּעַד עוֹר (איוב ב'), מָגֵן בַּעֲדִי (תהלים ג'), הִתְפַּלֵּל בְּעַד עֲבָדֶיךָ (שמואל א' י"ב) כְּנֶגֶד עֲבָדֶיךָ:

(2 Kings 4:4) "Close the door in front of thyself (בעדך) and in front of (ובעד) thy sons";

(Job 2:4) "skin in front of (as a protection for) (בעד) skin";

(Psalms 3:4) "a shield in front of me ובעדי":

(1 Samuel 12:19) "Pray (בעד) thy servants" which means כנגד in front of (i. e. on behalf of, as a protection for) thy servants.

HOW RASHI USES HIS SOURCES

Three comments, three source-moves

On ‘ראיתי צדיק’ (7:1) Rashi quotes the midrash by name — (ב"ר), Bereshit Rabbah 32:3 — and compresses its etiquette rule into a gloss: ‘מכאן שאומרים מקצת שבחו של אדם בפניו’ — only part of a man's praise is said in his presence. The relationship is explicit attribution with tight paraphrase: the seam between ‘צדיק תמים’ (6:9, said about Noah) and ‘צדיק’ (7:1, said to Noah) becomes the proof-text for the rule. On ‘הטהורה’ (7:2) the move is bolder: ‘שלמד נח תורה למדנו’ — we learn that Noah studied Torah. An aggadic inference (Bereshit Rabbah) is installed as the premise of peshat: Noah could only have known which animals were ‘clean’ centuries before Sinai if he had studied Torah.

On ‘ויהי הגשם’ (7:12) Rashi stages an explicit peshat/aggadah pivot. Why does verse 12 say גשם (rain) when verse 17 says מבול (flood)? ‘כשהורידן הורידן ברחמים’ — when God brought the

y Jev (jev-1.13.0). Mikra: Sefaria Hebrew + Targum Onkelos. Rashi: Sefaria; sources via Sefaria links. Lexicons: Klein, Jastrow, BDB via Sefaria; Maagarim via the Historical Dictionary Pr

PARSHAT NOACH

Mercy, presumption, and the animals boarding the ark.

Monday, 12 October 2026 · Aliyah 2/7 (Genesis 7:1-7:16) · Daf Bekhorot 24

waters down, He brought them down in mercy; only when they refused to repent did they become a flood. The aggadah (Rosh Hashanah 11b; Bereshit Rabbah 31:12) does not decorate the verse — it resolves a terminological seam, turning two words for water into a theology of delayed judgment.

WORD STUDIES

Three words from the aliyah

Three words that carry the aliyah — traced here through the aliyah's own verses, since the Maagarim citation sweeps were blocked this morning (see the daf's Maagarim section). CAL (cal.huc.edu) prohibits scraping, so Aramaic coverage here is Jastrow/BDB via Sefaria.

שִׁבְעָה

Klein · שבעה

— 'shiv'a h', short for שבעת ימי אבלות (the seven days of mourning held for a near relative).

Jastrow · שבעה

Klein · שבעה

f.n.

שבעה (seven): the aliyah's structural number. Seven pairs of clean animals and birds (7:2–3), seven days' warning (7:4), and after seven days the waters came (7:10). The word organizes the whole boarding in sevens — sevens of animals, sevens of days — and the seven-day unit reaches back to the creation week: the flood is an un-creation measured in the same sevens as the creation. Onkelos keeps the numeral transparent (שבעה שבעה שבעא שבעא), letting the repetition do the work.

אַרְעָא

Jastrow · ארעא

f.

— (רע, h. q. v.) [the brittle] land, earth, ground, field. Targ. Gen. I, 1. Targ. Y. Gen. XVI, 5; a. fr.—B. Bath. 29ᵃ חדא א' one field; v. באגא.—Bekh. 25ᵇ דחשוכא א' a land of darkness (Babylon); a. fr.—Sabb. 65ᵃ בת א'

Jastrow · ארעא

m.

— (ארע I) accident, occurrence. Targ. Ruth II, 3.—[*Pl. ארעייא evils, diseases. Targ. Y. Deut. XXVIII, 60 (prob. to be read מרעיא).]

Klein · ארעא

f.n.

ארעא (earth): Onkelos's unvarying rendering of ארץ throughout the flood narrative — על ארעא (7:4, 7:12), על אפי כל (7:3). It is the most frequent noun in the Targum of these verses, and fittingly so: the earth is what is about to be unmade. The Hebrew ארץ and the Aramaic

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אֶרֶץ sit side by side in every verse, the translation keeping the doomed world constantly in view.

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